
መጽሐፈ ገጽወጽ ✱ THE BOOK OF GITSEW

INTRODUCTION

The *Book of Gitsew*, is the third of the 4 Books of the Sinodos (*vide infra*); together with the *Book of Abtilis*, it provides two versions of one body of law, governing the conduct of the clergy – the latter is the fuller of the two, and covers the same ground at greater length.

The [Ge'ez text](#) here presented is that of Winandus Fell's 1871 transcription[§], which he constructed from 3 MSS: *Berlin Or 398* ('*Codex A*', 17th Century), *Berlin Or 396* ('*Codex B*', 18th Century) and a MS held in the Tübingen Public Library, *M. a. IX. 7* ('*Codex T*'). The English text is, essentially, that of [Breandan Lumpkin's 2026 translation](#)[¶]. The work is also preserved in Arabic, Syriac, and Coptic[▽] MSS, and in Greek fragments.

AUTHORSHIP AND DATES

Church tradition attributes the text of the *Book of Gitsew* to the Twelve Apostles. Within the Ethiopian tradition, the sections of the Sinodos (including Te'ezaz, Gitsew, and Abtilis) are sometimes colloquially referred to as the *Books of Clement* (specifically 1st, 2nd, and 3rd Clement). This implies they were pseudo-historically communicated by St Peter to his disciple, Clement of Rome.

However, modern textual scholarship establishes that the Sinodos is a compilation of pseudepigraphal church orders, local council decrees (such as Nicaea, Antioch, and Laodicea), and liturgical statutes. The text was written by anonymous Christian redactors in Egypt and the Levant, who compiled various traditional early Christian pseudo-apostolic rulings into singular volumes.

—| VIII-X-MMXXVI |—

§ Winandus Fell, "*Canones Apostolorum Aethiopice*," Leipzig: F. A. Brockhaus, 1871.

¶ Breandan Lumpkin, "*The Ethiopian Sinodos: Lost Books of the Ethiopian Bible*," Fifth Estate Publishing, Blountsville, AL, 2026.

▽ Henry Tattam, "*The Apostolic Constitutions or Canons of the Apostles in Coptic*," London, 1848.

መጽሐፈ፡ግጽው፡

በስመ፡ አብ፡ ወወልድ፡ ወመንፈስ፡ ቅዱስ፡ አሐዱ፡
አምላክ ።

ዝንቱ፡ ሲኖዶስ፡ ዘቤተ፡ ክርስቲያን፡ ዘወሀብዎ፡ ሐዋርያት፡
በእደ፡ ቀሌምንጦስ፡ ዘለአክዎ፡ ቀዲመ ።

PROLOGUE

In the name of the Father, and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit,
one God.

This is the Synod of the Church, which the Apostles handed
down by the hand of Clement, whom they sent long ago.ⁱ

PROLOGUE

ⁱ Another possible reading for 'long ago' is 'in the beginning'.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፩ ።

በእንተ፡ ስፍነ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶሳት፡ የሀልዉ፡ በሢመተ፡
ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ ።

ይሠየም፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ በ፪፡ አው፡ በ፫ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶሳት፤
ወቀሲስ፡ ወዲያቆን፡ ወእለ፡ ተርፉ፡ ሥዩማን፡ ይሠየሙ፡
በመባሕተ፡ ፩ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ ።

CANON 1

HOW MANY BISHOPS OUGHT TO BE PRESENT AT THE
ORDINATION OF A BISHOP

Let a bishop be ordained by two or three bishops. But let a
presbyter and a deacon and the rest of the clergy be ordained
by one bishop only. ⁱ

CANON 1

ⁱ All the MSS read በመባሕተ፡ ፩ኤጲስ፡ (*‘with the permission of one bishop’*) and Fell’s printed Ge’ez keeps it, as does his Latin; *‘by one bishop only’* is his conjecture in the note, made on the similar word በባሕተቱ (*‘alone’*) and it is the reading followed here. Recension II adds that ordinations are to be held on the Lord’s Day.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፪ ።

በእንተ፡ ዘመፍትው፡ ያብኡ፡ ውስተ፡ ምሥዋዕ ።

ለእመ፡ አብአ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ አው፡ ቀሲስ፡ ምንተኒ፡ ውስተ፡ ምሥዋዕ፡ ለእግዚአብሔር፡ ባዕደ፡ ዘእንበለ፡ ዘአዘዘነ፡ ዘያብኡ፡ ወያዕርጉ፡ ቊርባነ፤ አው፡ ያበውእ፡ መዓረ፡ አው፡ ሐሊበ፡ አው፡ እምአዕዋፍ፡ አው፡ እምእንስሳ፡ ካልእ፡ ዘእንበለ፡ ዘአዘዘ፡ እግዚእነ፡ ለይትመተር ። ወኢይደሉ፡ ያብኡ፡ ምንተኒ፡ ውስተ፡ ምሥዋዕ፡ ዘእንበለ፡ ሠዊት፡ ወአስካል፡ በመዋዕሊሁ፡ ወቅብአ፡ መኅቶት፡ ንጹሕ፡ ወዕጣን፡ በጊዜ፡ ቊርባን፡ ንጹሕ ። ወእለ፡ ተርፉ፡ ፍሬያት፡ ይፈንዉ፡ ውስተ፡ ቤት፡ ወይኩን፡ ለኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ወለቀሳውስት፤ ወባሕቱ፡ ኢያብእዎሙ፡ ውስተ፡ ምሥዋዕ ። ወይትካፈልዎሙ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ወቀሳውስት፡ ወለእለ፡ ተርፉ፡ ሥዩማን ።

CANON 2

ON THE THINGS THAT OUGHT TO BE BROUGHT TO THE ALTAR

If any bishop or presbyter brings to the altar of the Lord anything other than what we commanded to be brought and offered – whether honey, or milk,ⁱ or anything of birds or of other beasts, beyond what our Lord appointed – let him be deposed. Nor is it lawful to bring anything else to the altar except ears of corn and grapes in their season, and oil for the holy lamp, and incense at the time of the holy sacrifice. Let the other fruits be sent to the house, and let them belong to the bishop and the presbyters; but let them not bring them to the altar. And let the bishop and the presbyters distribute them also to the rest of the clergy.

CANON 2

ⁱ The Coptic adds ‘intoxicating drink made in place of wine’ (ἰε οὐκικερῶν ἐαγθαμιοῦ ἐπιμα νογρηπ) and Abtilis has ‘wine made by fire’, or ‘wine made by the sun’.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፫ ።

ወኢይስድዱ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ወቀሲስ፡ ወዲያቆን፡
ብእሲቶ፡ በምክንያተ፡ መልእክተ፡ እግዚአብሔር ።
ወለእመ፡ ሰደዱ፡ ይትፈለጡ፤ ወለእመ፡ ኢያግብእዋ፡
ወኢያብእዋ፡ ይትመተሩ ።

CANON 3

Do not let a bishop or presbyter or deacon put away his wife under pretext of the divine serviceⁱ. If they do put her away, let them be excommunicated; and, if they do not bring her back and receive her, let them be deposed.

CANON 3

ⁱ For ‘the divine service’, the Greek reads *εὐλάβεια* (‘reverence’).

ትእዛዝ፡፬ ።

በእንተ፡ ዕለት፡ ዘመፍትው፡ ይግበሩ፡ ፋሲካ ።

ወለእመ፡ ገብረ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ አው፡ ቀሲስ፡ አው፡ ዲያቆን፡
ቅድስተ፡ ፋሲካ፡ ምስለ፡ አይሁድ፡ እምቅድመ፡ ይዔሪ፡ ሌሊት፡
ወመዓልት፡ ለይትመተር ።

CANON 4

ON THE DAY ON WHICH PASCHA SHOULD BE CELEBRATED

If any bishop or presbyter or deacon celebrates the Holy
Pascha with the Jews, before the equinox, let him be
deposed.

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ወኢይደመሩ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጵስ፡ ወቀሲስ፡ ወዲያቆን፡ ውስተ፡
ተግባረ፡ ዝንቱ፡ ዓለም ። ወለእመ፡ ተደመሩ፡
ይትፈለጡ ።

CANON 5

Let not bishop and presbyter and deacon entangle themselves in
the affairs of this world; and if they do entangle themselves, let
them be deposed.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፮ ።

እመሂ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጵስ፡ አው፡ አሐዱ፡ እምካህናት፡
ዘኢተመጠወ፡ ቊርባነ፡ በጊዜ፡ ቅዳሴ፡ ይንግር፡ ምክንያተ፡
በዝንቱ፤ ወለእመ፡ ኮነ፡ ዘኢይደልዎ፡ ይሰረይ፡ ሎቱ ።
ወለእመ፡ ኢነገረ፡ ምክንያቶ፡ ይሰደድ፤ እስመ፡ ኮነ፡
መርሐ፡ ከመ፡ ይኩን፡ ለሕዝብ፡ ኀጢአተ፡ ወረሰዮሙ፡
ይትዐቀፉ፡ ላዕለ፡ ዘአዕረገ፡ ቊርባነ፡ ከመ፡ ዘኢያዕረገ፡
በንጽሕ ።

CANON 6

If any bishop, or any one of the clergy, does not receive the Eucharist at the time of the Liturgy, let him state the cause of it; and if something has befallen him that makes him unworthy,ⁱ let pardon be granted him. But, if he does not state his cause, let him be excommunicated, since he has become to men the author of scandal, and has caused them to take offence at him who offered the sacrifice, as though he had not sacrificed in purity.

CANON 6

ⁱ For 'and if something has befallen him that makes him unworthy', the Greek reads καὶ ἐὰν ᾗ αἰτία εὐλογος ('and if there is a reasonable cause'), which has the same sense as the Coptic.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፯ ።

ኩሉ፡ መሃይምን፡ ዘይበውእ፡ ውስተ፡ ቤተ፡ ክርስቲያን፡
ወይሰምዕ፡ መጻሕፍተ፡ ወኢይቀውም፡ እስከ፡ ይገብሩ፡
ጸሎተ፡ ወኢይትሜጠው፡ ቀርባን፡ ቅዱስ፡ ወኢይጸልዩ፡
ላዕሌሁ፡ ወይደልዎ፡ ይሰደድ፤ እስመ፡ ገብረ፡ ጋእዘ፡
ወሁከተ፡ ለቤተ፡ ክርስቲያን ።

CANON 7

Any believer who enters the church and hears the Scriptures,
but does not remain until the prayers are ended, nor receives
the Holy Eucharist – let them make no prayers for such a one.
Separation is his due, since he prepares strife and disturbance
for the church.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፰ ።

ወለእመቦ፡ ዘጸለየ፡ ምስለ፡ ዘኢይሳተፍ፡ ምስጢረ፡
ወለእመሂ፡ በቤት፡ ይሰደድ ።

CANON 8

If anyone prays with one who has no part in the Mystery,ⁱ even
in his own house, let him be excommunicated.

CANON 8

ⁱ Lumpkin here adds '*that is, with one who has been cut off*' (surrounded by dashes) – following a bracketed note in Fell's Latin translation. The Coptic text has the same sense: $\text{nem pet koinōnin an ḥmγctḥrion}$.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፱ ።

ወኢይጸልዩ፡ ምስሉ፡ ዘተሰደ ።

ወለእመ፡ ጸለየ፡ ኣሓዱ፡ እምካህናት፡ ምስሉ፡ ኣሓዱ፡ ካህን፡
ዘተሰደ፡ ይሰደድ፡ ውእቱኒ ።

CANON 9

AND THEY SHALL NOT PRAY WITH ONE CUT OFFⁱ

If any cleric prays with a cleric who has been cut off, let him
too be excommunicated.

CANON 9

ⁱ Lumpkin has a longer subtitle: *THAT CLERGY SHOULD NOT PRAY WITH A CLERIC WHO HAS BEEN CUT OFF.*

ትእዛዝ፡ ፲ ።

ወለእመ፡ ሐረ፡ አሐዱ፡ እምካህናት፡ አው፡ ሕዝባዊ፡ ዘተሰደ፡
ውስተ፡ ሀገር፡ ከመ፡ ዘኢተሰደ፡ ወይበውእ፡ ውስተ፡ ይእቲ፡
ሀገር፡ ዘእንበለ፡ በመባሕት፡ ወይሠየም፡ ይሰደድ፡ ውእቱሂ፡
ወዘሢሞሂ ። ወለእመ፡ ሀሎ፡ አፍኣ፡ ይሰደድ፡ እንተ፡
አፍኣሁ፡ ነዋኅ፡ መዋዕለ፤ እስመ፡ ሐሰወ፡ ቤተ፡ ክርስቲያኑ፡
ለእግዚአብሔር ።

CANON 10

If any cleric or layman who has been cut off goes to another city as though he were not cut off, and enters that city without permissionⁱ and is ordained: let both he and the one who ordained him be excommunicated. But, if he had already been cut off, let him be cut off for a longer time, because he has deceived the church of the Lord.

CANON 10

ⁱ After 'permission', Fell adds in his Latin translation *episcopi* ('of the bishop') in brackets.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፲ወ፩ ።

ኢመፍትወ፡ ለኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ይኅድግ፡ ሢመቶ፡ ወይሆነም፡
ኀበ፡ ካልእ፡ ወለእመ፡ አስተሓመምዎ፡ ሕዝብ፡ ዘእንበለ፡
በምክንያተ፡ ረባሕ፡ ወያስተሓምምዎ፡ ከመ፡ ይግበር፡ ከማሁ፡
እስመ፡ ይክል፡ ያርብሐሙ፡ ለእለ፡ በህየ፡ በነገረ፡ ጽድቅ ።
ወዘንተኒ፡ ኢይግበር፡ በባሕቲቱ፤ አላ፡ በፍትሐ፡ ብዙኃን፡
ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶሳት፡ ወበዐቢይ፡ አስተብቀዎት፡ ፈድፋደ ።

CANON 11

It is not lawful for a bishop to abandon his own diocese and be
ordained in another;ⁱ and, if the people remove him without
just cause, let them also be removed, because he is able to
increase those who are there in the matter of truth. But let him
not do this alone, upon his own authority, but by the judgment
of many bishops and upon the greatest entreaty.

CANON 11

ⁱ Lumpkin ends the first sentence: *even though the people should urge him to it – unless it be for the good, and unless they urge him to do that which might offer some benefit to those who are there by the word of truth.*

ትእዛዝ፡ ፲ወ፪ ።

እመሂ፡ ቀሲስ፡ አው፡ ዲያቆን፡ አው፡ አሐዱ፡ እመዓርገ፡
ክህነት፡ ኀደገ፡ መንበሮ፡ ወሐረ፡ ኀበ፡ ካልእ፡ መንበር፡
ወይነብር፡ በውእቱ፡ መካን፡ ነዋኀ፡ መዋዕለ፡ ፈሊስ፡
ዘእንበለ፡ በመባሕተ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ንሕነ፡ ንኤዝዝ፡ ከመ፡
ኢይትለአክ፡ ለዓለም፤ ወፈድፋደስ፡ ለእመ፡ ለአክ፡ ኀቤሁ፡
ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ከመ፡ ይግባእ፡ ኀበ፡ መካኑ፡ ወኢሰምዖ፡
ይሰደድ፡ እምሂመቱ፡ ወይቅረብ፡ በመካን፡ ኀበ፡ ሀሎ፡ ከመ፡
ሕዝባዊ ። ወለእመ፡ ተወክፎ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ዘሀሎ፡ ኀቤሁ፡
ከመ፡ ፩እምካህናት፡ ወይሬኢ፡ ዘንተ፡ ኩነኔ፡ ዘፈታሕነ፡
ከመ፡ ከንቱ፡ ይሰደድ፡ ውእቱኒ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ከመ፡
መምህረ፡ ዕልወተ፡ ሕግ ።

CANON 12

If any presbyter or deacon or anyone from the grades of the clergy abandons his own see and goes off to another, and remains there wandering many days without the bishop's permission: him we order to exercise his office no longer. And if the bishop moreover sends to him that he should return to his own place, and he does not obey: let him be separated from his office, and in the place where he is let him communicate as a layman. But, if the bishop with whom he is staying receives him as a cleric, and reckons as nothing this decree which we have made: let this bishop also be excommunicated, as a teacher of the breaking of law.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፲፱፫ ።

በእንተ፡ ዘአውሰበ፡ ክልኤተ፡ አው፡ ማዕስበ ።

ዘአውሰበ፡ ክልኤተ፡ አው፡ ዕቅብተ፡ እምድኅረ፡ ጥምቀት፡
ኢይከውኖ፡ ይሠየም፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ወኢቀሲስ፡ ወኢዲያቆነ፡
ወኢይደሉ፡ ይትጎለቀኑ፡ ምስለ፡ ሥዩማን፡ ካህናት፡ ግሙራ ።

ዘአውሰበ፡ ማዕስበ፡ አው፡ እንተ፡ ተሐዘብዋ፡ አው፡ እንተ፡
አስተኅፈርዋ፡ አው፡ ዘማዊተ፡ አው፡ አመተ፡ አው፡ እንተ፡
ተሐውር፡ ኀበ፡ ተውኔት፡ ኢይከውኖ፡ ይሠየም፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡
ወኢቀሲስ፡ ወኢዲያቆነ፡ ወኢይትጎለቀኑ፡ ግሙራ፡
እምሥዩማን፡ ካህናት፤ አው፡ ዘነበረ፡ ምስለ፡ ክልኤ፡ አጋት፡
አው፡ ወለተ፡ እኑሁ፡ ኢይከውኖ፡ ይኩን፡ ካህነ ።

CANON 13

ON HIM WHO HAS MARRIED TWICE OR MARRIED A WIDOW

He who, after baptism, has taken two wives, or a concubine, cannot be ordained bishop or presbyter or deacon, nor ought he in any way to be numbered among the clergy.

He who has married a widow, or a woman under suspicion, or one who has been put to shame,ⁱ or a harlot, or a maidservant, or an actress, cannot be ordained bishop or presbyter or deacon, nor be numbered among the clergy. Nor can he be a cleric who has lived with two sisters, or with his brother's daughter.

CANON 13

ⁱ In place of 'one who has been put to shame', the Greek text has 'one who has been divorced' (ἐκβεβλημένην); Fell's Ge'ez here (እንተ፡ አስተኅፈርዋ፡) follows the Coptic (οὔτι ἐαγααυε).

ትእዛዝ፡ ፲ወ፬ ።

ካህን፡ ዘይትሐበይ፡ ብእሴ፡ ይትመተር ።

CANON 14

A cleric who gives surety, let him be deposed.ⁱ

CANON 14

ⁱ The Coptic reads rather *‘One who (takes) a man as a pledge’* (ἕθνασι ῥωμι ἑωπειτῶρι). After *‘surety’*, Lumpkin adds *‘for anyone’*.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፲፬፮ ።

በእንተ፡ ኅጽዋን ።

ለእመ፡ ተኅጽወ፡ እምሰብእ፡ በትዕግልት፡ አው፡ ለእመ፡
መተርዎ፡ ኅፍረቶ፡ በውስተ፡ ጸብእ፡ አው፡ ተወልደ፡
ከማሁ፡ ለእመ፡ ይደልዎ፡ ይሠየም፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ ።
ወእመስ፡ ኅጸወ፡ ርእሶ፡ በመባሕቱ፡ ኢይኩን፡ እምሥዩማን፤
እስመ፡ ኮነ፡ ቀታሌ፡ ነፍሱ፡ ወጸላኤ፡ ለፍጥረተ፡
እግዚአብሔር ። ወጄእምሥዩማን፡ ለእመ፡ መተረ፡ ኅፍረቶ፡
ይሰዐር፤ እስመ፡ ቀታሌ፡ ነፍሱ፡ ውእቱ፡ ባሕቲቱ ።
ወሕዝባዊ፡ ዘየሐጹ፡ ርእሶ፡ ይሰደድ፡ ሠለስተ፡ ዓመተ፤
እስመ፡ ኮነ፡ ፀረ፡ ለሕይወቱ፡ ባሕቲቱ ።

CANON 15

CONCERNING EUNUCHS

If anyone has been made a eunuch by force at the hands of men, or if in warⁱ his manhood was cut away, or if he was so born, and he is worthy: let him be ordained bishop. But if he has castrated himself, he cannot become a cleric, since he is his own murderer and has made himself an enemy of the creation of God. And if any cleric cuts off his own members: let him be deposed, since he is nothing other than his own murderer. But a layman who cuts himself, let him be cut off for three years, since he has become an enemy of his own life.

CANON 15

ⁱ Fell doubts whether the Ge'ez word here rendered 'war' (ጸብእ) can carry the sense of the Greek διωγμός ('persecution'), and notes that the lexica do not record it.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፲ወ፯ ።

በእንተ፡ ዘዘመወ፡ እው፡ መሐል፡ በሐሰት፡ አው፡ ሰረቀ ።
ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ አው፡ ቀሲስ፡ አው፡ ዲያቆን፡ ዘይትረከብ፡
በዝሙት፡ አው፡ በመሐላ፡ ሐሰት፡ አው፡ በሰሪቅ፡ ይሰወር፡
ወኢይሰደድ፤ እስመ፡ ይብል፡ እግዚአብሔር፡ ኢይትቤቀል፡
ካዕበ፡ በ፩አበላ ።

CANON 16

ON HIM WHO HAS FORNICATED OR SWORN FALSELY OR STOLEN
A bishop or presbyter or deacon who has been caught in
fornication or perjury or theft, let him be deposed; but let him
not be cut off. For the Scripture says: The Lord will not exact
vengeance twice for one crime. ⁱ

CANON 16

ⁱ Fell notes the clause may equally be rendered with the Lord speaking: *For the Lord says, "I will not exact it."*

ትእዛይ፡፲ወ፯ ።

ⁱወካዕበ፡እለ፡ ተርፉ፡ ሥዩማን ።

እለ፡ እሙንቱ፡ እናጉንሰጢስ፡ ወመዘምራን፡ ሶበ፡ ይበውኡ፡
ውስተ፡ ክህነት፡ ወፈቀዱ፡ አውሰቦ፡ ያውሰቡ፤ ወንሕነ፡
ንኤዝዞሙ፡ ለባሕቲቶሙ፡ እንዘ፡ ሀለዉ፡ አናጉንሰጢስ፡
ያውሰቡ ። ወባሕቱ፡ ኢይከውኖሙ፡ እምድጎረ፡ ተሠይሙ ።

CANON 17

AND SO THE REST OF THE CLERGY ⁱⁱ

Those who are readers and cantors, if they enter the clergy and wish to take a wife, let them take one. But we order them to marry only while they are readers; it is not lawful for them once they have attained a higher order.

CANON 17

- ⁱ The last letter of the first word in the title is clearly wrong (Fell marks it with an over-written 'X') – the word should obviously read ትእዛዝ (as elsewhere).
- ⁱⁱ Fell notes that the text here given as the subtitle should possibly be part of the preceding canon.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፲፬ ።

በእንተ፡ ካህን፡ ዘይዘብጥ፡ ኩሎ ።

ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ አው፡ ቀሲስ፡ ዘይዘብጥ፡ ክርስቲያናዊ፡ አው፡
ዘኢየሱስ፡ ሶበ፡ ይኤብስ፡ ወይፈቅድ፡ በዝንቱ፡ ግብር፡
ከመ፡ ዘያፈርሆሙ፡ ለሰብእ፡ ንሕነ፡ ንኤዝዝ፡ ከመ፡ ይሰወር፤
እስመ፡ ኢአዘዘ፡ እግዚእነ፡ ከመ፡ ንግብር፡ ዘንተ፡
ወኢበአሐቲ፡ መካን፤ እስመ፡ ሶበ፡ ይዘብጥዎ፡ ኢዘበጠ፡
ወእንዘ፡ ይጸዕልዎ፡ ኢጸዕለ፡ ወእንዘ፡ ያሐምምዎ፡
ኢተቀየመ፡ ወኢተምዕዐ ።

CANON 18

CONCERNING A CLERIC WHO STRIKES ANYONE

A bishop or presbyter who strikes a Christian or an unbeliever after he has sinned, and by this means wishes to strike terror into men, we order to be deposed. For nowhere did our Lord instruct us to do this; because when they struck him, he did not strike; and when they cursed him, he did not curse; and when they afflicted him with pain, he neither prepared vengeance nor was angry.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፲፱ ።

በእንተ፡ ዘተስዕረ፡ በርቱዕ፡ አምካህናት ።

እመሂ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ አው፡ ቀሲስ፡ አው፡ ዲያቆን፡ ዘተስዕረ፡
በርቱዕ፡ በእንተ፡ ኅጢአት፡ ዘተዐውቀ፡ ደፈረ፡ ወቀርበ፡
ይእኅዝ፡ መልእክቶ፡ እንተ፡ ትካት፡ [በመዋዕለ፡ መባሕት፡]
ወዝንቱ፡ ይርሐቅ፡ እምቤተ፡ ክርስቲያን፡ ግሙራ ።

CANON 19

ON ONE JUSTLY DEPOSED FROM THE CLERGY

If any bishop or presbyter or deacon, justly deposed for a manifest crime, is insolent and comes forward to occupy his former office [on the days of the offeringⁱ]: let him depart from the church altogether.

CANON 19

ⁱ Fell does not translate the words given in brackets, noting that they are obscure and suggesting they may be a gloss on እንተ፡ ትካት፡ ('former'). Alternatively, following the reading of *Codex B* (በመዋዕለ፡ መስሕት፡), one might translate 'in the days of offence' – meaning, if he dared to resume his former office without having been absolved of the crime and without having been granted permission to take up the duty again. Or did the Ethiopic translator of the Coptic (mis)read ḿCHOY NIBEN ('in the days of sin') instead of ḿCHOY NOBE ('in all days', i.e., always)?

ትእዛዝ፡ ፳ ።

በእንተ፡ ዘይሠየም፡ በሕልያን ።

እመሂ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ አው፡ ቀሲስ፡ አው፡ ዲያቆን፡
ዘይእኅዝ፡ መዓርገ፡ ክህነት፡ በሕልያን፡ ይሰወር ። ወይሰወር፡
ዘሚሞሂ፡ ወይትመተር፡ ለዝሉፋ፡ እምሥርዐተ፡ ክህነት፡
ወኢይሳተፍዎ፡ ወኢበምንተⁱኒ፤ በከመ፡ ረሰይክዎ፡ ለሲሞን፡
መሠርይ፡ እምኅቤየ፡ ኣነ፡ ጴጥሮስ ።

CANON 20

ON HIM WHO HAS BEEN ORDAINED BY GIFTS

If any bishop, presbyter, or deacon obtains the dignity of the clergy by gifts, let him be deposed; and let him also be deposed who ordained him, and let him be cut off forever from the order of priesthood.ⁱⁱ And let them have no fellowship with him – even as I, Peter, removed Simon Magus from me.

CANON 20

ⁱ Fell marks this letter with an over-written 'X', indicating that it is almost certainly incorrect.

ⁱⁱ Lumpkin ends the sentence, "...and let him be shut out for ever from the administration of the priesthood."

ትእዛዝ፡ ፳፩ ።

በእንተ፡ ዘይትራዳእ፡ ከመ፡ ይእኅዝ፡ ቤተ፡ ክርስቲያን ።
ለእመ፡ ተራድኦ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ምክኅና፡ በመኳንንተ፡
ዝንቱ፡ ዓለም፡ ወይመልክ፡ ቤተ፡ ክርስቲያን፡ ዘእምኅቤሆሙ፡
ለይትመተር፡ ወይሰደድ፡ ውእቱኒ፡ ወኹሎሙ፡ እለ፡
ተለውዎ ።

CANON 21

ON HIM WHO USES THE HELP OF PRINCES TO OBTAIN A CHURCH
If any bishop obtains a prefecture by the help of the princes of
this world, and possesses a church through them: let him be
deposed. And let both he himself and those who cleave to him
be cut off.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፳፬ ።

በእንተ፡ ቀሲስ፡ ዘይሜንን፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጵስ ።

ለእመ፡ መነነ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጵስ፡ ቀሲስ፡ ወይተፈለጥ፡
ወይገብር፡ ሎቱ፡ ምሥዋዐ፡ እንዘ፡ ኢይትረከብ፡ ላዕለ፡
ኤጲስ፡ ቆጵስ፡ ጌጋይ፡ በውስተ፡ ፍትሕ፡ በእንተ፡ ግብረ፡
እግዚአብሔር፡ እንዘ፡ ይረትዕ፡ ለይሰዐር፡ ከመ፡ መፍቀሬ፡
ሢመት፡ ውእቱ፡ ወኸሎሙ፡ ካህናት፡ እለ፡ ተለውዎ፤
እስመ፡ ዐላዊ፡ ውእቱ ። ወሕዝባውያን፡ እለ፡ ተለውዎ፡
ይሰደዱ ። ወዝንቱ፡ ይከውን፡ ሶበ፡ ይሴአሎሙ፡ ኤጲስ፡
ቆጵስ፡ ምዕረ፡ ወካዕበ፡ ወሥልሰ ።

CANON 22

ON A PRESBYTER WHO DESPISES HIS BISHOP

If a presbyter despises his bishop, and separates himself from him, and builds an altar for himself – while in judgment no crime is found in the bishop, since he is innocent by reason of his divine office – let him be deposed as one greedy for dignity, and with him all the clerics who cleave to him, because he is a rebel. But the laymen who cleave to him, let them be cut off. And let this be done when the bishop has exhorted them once, and twice, and a third time.

ትእዛዝ፡፳ወ፫ ።

በእንተ፡ ቀሲስ፡ አው፡ ዲያቆን፡ ዘሰደዶ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ ።
ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ለእመ፡ ሰደደ፡ⁱ ቀሲስ፡ አው፡ ዲያቆን ፡ካልእ፡
ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ኢይኅድጎ፡ ይባእ፡ ዘእንበለ፡ ለእመ፡ አብሒ፡
ውእቱ፡ ሰደዶ፡ አው፡ ለእመ፡ ሞተ ።

CANON 23

ON A PRESBYTER OR DEACON WHOM THE BISHOP HAS CUT OFF
If any bishop cuts off a presbyter or a deacon, let no other
bishop receive him, unless he who cut him off permits it, or
unless he is dead.

CANON 23

ⁱ There is no doubt that (with the Coptic version agreeing) ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ must be supplied before ለእመ፡ ሰደደ፡ . Otherwise, ሰደደ፡ would have to be changed to ተሰደ ('[if any presbyter or deacon] has been separated' – namely, by the bishop).

ትእዛዝ፡ ፳፬ ።

ኢይትወከፍ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ነኪር፡ ቀሲስ፡ ወዲያቆነ፡ እለ፡
ይትመጠው፡ ከመ፡ ንኡሳን፡ ካህናት፡ ዘእንበለ፡ ለእመበሙ፡
መባሕተ፡ ይሠየሙ፡ ወይደመሩ ። ወለእመ፡ ተኑ፡ ዜናውያነ፡
ጽድቅ፡ ይባኡ፤ ወእመ፡ እኮ፡ ዘይፈቅዱ፡ የሀብዎሙ፡
ወኢይደመሩ፤ እስመቦ፡ ብዙኃን፡ እሰ፡ ከመዝ፡ ከመ፡
ርሱሕ ።

CANON 24

Let no foreign bishop receive a presbyter or a deacon – those
who come to him to be received as inferior clergyⁱ – unless they
have permission to be ordained and joined to him. And, if they
are preachers of the truth, let them be received. But if not,
whatever they desire, do not give them, nor let them
administer; for, there are many like this.ⁱⁱ

CANON 24

- ⁱ I.e., those who come to him to be received as lower-ranking clerics. However, Fell strongly doubts whether his translation of the rather obscure words እለ፡ ይትመጠው፡ ከመ፡ ንኡሳን፡ ካህናት፡, or if the reading of *Codex T* (እላ፡) should be preferred instead ('but let him receive [them] as lower-ranking clerics'). Furthermore, judging by the *MSS*, it is uncertain whether one should read ይትመጠው or ይትመጠዉ.
- ⁱⁱ For the last two sentences, Lumpkin reads: *But if not, let there be given them what they ask, that is, whatever they need; but let them not be joined to him. For there are many wicked men of this kind.*

ትእዛዝ፡ ፳፬ ።

መፍትወ፡ ያእምር፡ ሊቀ፡ ጳጳሳት፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶሳተ፡ ኩሉ፡ ብሔር ። ወይደልዎሙ፡ ያእምርዎ፡ መኑ፡ ውእቱ፡ ቀዳሚ፡ በኅቤሆሙ፡ ወይስምይዎ፡ ሊቀ፤ ወኢይግበሩ፡ ዐቢየ፡ ምክረ፡ ዘእንበለ፡ በምክረ፡ ዘየዐቢ፤ ወይግበሩ፡ ለለጅግብሮሙ፡ ዘይደልዎሙ፡ ለሢመቶሙ፡ ወለሕዝብ፡ እለ፡ ውስተ፡ ምክርናኖሙ ። ወባሕቱ፡ ዘይሠየም፡ ሊቀ፡ ላዕሌሆሙ፡ ኢይግበር፡ ወኢምንትኒ፡ ዘእንበለ፡ በምክረ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶሳት፡ ኩሉሙ፤ ከመዝ፡ ኩሉሙ፡ ይኩኑ፡ አሐደ፡ ኅብረተ፡ ወይሴባሕ፡ እግዚአብሔር፡ በክርስቶስ፡ ኢየሱስ፡ ወመንፈስ፡ ቅዱስ ።

ወኢይትኅበል፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ከመ፡ ይሢም፡ አፍኣ፡ እምኩናኑ፡ ኀበ፡ ዘኢኮነ፡ ዚአሁ፡ አዕጻዳተ ። ወለእመ፡ ተረክበ፡ ከመ፡ ገብረ፡ ዘንተ፡ ዘእንበለ፡ ምክረ፡ ርእሰ፡ ውእቱ፡ መካን፡ ወአዕጻዳት፡ ወአህጉር፡ ለይሰዐር፡ ውእቱኒ፡ ወእለ፡ ሢሞሙኒ ።

CANON 25

The metropolitanⁱ ought to know the bishops of the whole province; and these ought to know which among them is first, and to name him metropolitan. Nor let them pronounce a grave sentence without the will of the first. Let each one manage his own affair, which belongs to him by reason of his own diocese and of the people who are under his jurisdiction. But let not even he who is set over them as metropolitan do anything without the counsel of all the bishops. ⁱⁱ So, all may be one, and God will be glorified through Christ Jesus and the Holy Spirit.

Let no bishop dare to make an ordination outside his own diocese, in villages that do not pertain to him. And, if he is found to have done this without the knowledge of him who holds the primacy in that place and in those villages and cities: let both he and those he ordained be deposed.

CANON 25

ⁱ Where this canon says ‘metropolitan’, the Ge’ez may equally be rendered ‘patriarch’.

ⁱⁱ Lumpkin opens the sentence, “In this way, let them all form one fellowship.”

ትእዛዝ፡ ፳ወ፯ ።

ወለእመ፡ ተሠይመ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ወኢገሠጸ፡ ወኢጎለየ፡
በእንተ፡ ሕዝብ፡ ዘተውህበ፡ ሎቱ፡ ይትፈለጥ፡ እስከ፡
ይጌሥጽ፤ ወከመዝ፡ ቀሲስ፡ ወዲያቆን ። ወእመ፡ ሐረ፡
ወኢየጎድግ፡ ከመ፡ ይባእ፡ ወአኮ፡ ውእቱ፡ በምክሩ፡ አላ፡
በምክረ፡ ሕዝብ፡ ወለሊሁሰ፡ ይንበር፡ እንዘ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡
ውእቱ፤ ወካህናትሰ፡ እለ፡ ውስተ፡ ሀገር፡ ይትፈለጡ፤ እስመ፡
ኢመሀሩ፡ ለሕዝብ፡ ከመዝ ።

CANON 26

If any bishop has been ordained, and has not taught nor taken care of the people committed to him: let him be cut off until he teaches. And, in the same way, presbyter and deacon. But, if he goes to teach and the people refuse to receive him, through their decision rather than his own, let the bishop retain his office; but let the clergy of that city be cut off, because they did not admonish the people in such a case. ⁱ

CANON 26

ⁱ Fell's Latin contrasts the bishop's decision with the people's, and the reading above follows him; the passage involves editorial reconstruction and comparison with the Coptic (ἔγωπαι δε ἀφωσανόμεναί ἡμεῖς τὴν πόλιν); it is not an unproblematic Ge'ez reading.

ትእዛዝ፡፳ወ፯ ።

CANON 27

ወይኩን፡ ጉባኤ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶሳት፡ ካዕበ፡ በበዓመት፡
ወይጠይቁ፡ በእንተ፡ ሥርዐተ፡ መልእክተ፡ እግዚአብሔር፡
ወይፈክሩ፡ ስሕተታተ፡ ወዕቅፍተ፡ ዘይከውን፡ በቤተ፡
ክርስቲያን ። ወቀዳሚ፡ ጉባኤ፡ ይኩን፡ በመንፈቀ፡
ጳጳስ፡ ወካል፡ ጉባኤ፡ አመ፡ ፲ወ፪ለጥቅምት ።

Let a synod of bishops be held twice in the year; and let them
examine the administration of the divine office, and set right
the errors and offences which are in the church. Let the first
synod be held at mid-Pentecost, and the second synod on the
twelfth day of the month Tekemt. ⁱ

CANON 27

ⁱ 'Tekemt' (ጥቅምት) begins on the 10th of October, and answers to the Roman October. Mid-Pentecost is the fourth week after the Pascha; the Arabic titles read plainly 'in the fourth week after the Pascha'. From this apostolic decree, the Abyssinian church took the name of a feast kept on the 18th of Miyazya, which they call the Feast of the Assembly of the Bishops.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፳ወ፰ ።

CANON 28

ወየጎሊ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጵስ፡ በእንተ፡ ንዋየ፡ⁱ ቤተ፡ ክርስቲያን፡
ወይሥርዖሙ፡ ከመዘ፡ እግዚአብሔር፡ ነጻረ፡ ላዕሌሁ ።
ወኢይደልዎ፡ ይንግእ፡ እምኔሆሙ፡ ረባሐ፡ ሎቱ፡
ለባሕቲቱ ። ወኢየሀብ፡ ንዋየ፡ እግዚአብሔር፡ ለውሉደ፡
ዘመዱ፡ ወለእመሂ፡ ኮኑ፡ ነዳያን ። ወኢይደልዎ፡ ይንግድ፡
ንዋየ፡ ቤተ፡ ክርስቲያን፡ በምክንያተ፡ እሙንቱ ።

Let the bishop have the care of the goods of the church, and let him administer them as one upon whom the Lord looks. It is not lawful for him to take anything from them for himself alone as gain, nor to give the goods of the Lord to his own kindred, even though they are poor. Nor is it lawful for him to sell the goods of the church under pretext of them.

CANON 28

ⁱ Fell did not hesitate to supply the word ንዋየ፡ before ቤተ፡ ክርስቲያን፡, even though it is missing from the MSS. For, quite apart from the fact that this word appears in the Greek text as well as in all the versions, the plural suffixes on the words ይሥርዖሙ and እግዚአብሔር already require it. In *Codex T*, ላዕሌሁሙ is read instead of ላዕሌሁ; its suffix must also refer to ንዋየ (as things which God looks on).

ትእዛዝ፡፳ወ፱ ።

በእንተ፡ ተማክሮ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ ።

ኢይግበር፡ ወኢመኑሂ፡ እምቀሳውስት፡ ወዲያቆናት፡
ወኢምንተኒ፡ ዘእንበለ፡ በምክረ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፤ እስመ፡
ወእቱ፡ ዘተኣምነ፡ ላዕለ፡ ሕዝበ፡ እግዚአብሔር፡ ወወእቱ፡
ካዕበ፡ ዘያወሥእ፡ በእንተ፡ ነፍሶሙ ።

CANON 29

ON TAKING COUNSEL WITH THE BISHOP

Let none of the presbyters and deacons do anything except by the counsel of the bishop. For he it is to whom the people of God has been entrusted; and he it is also who will render account for their souls.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፴ ።

ወያእምሩ፡ ንዋየ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ በባሕቲቱ፡ ለእመቦ፡ ንዋየ፤
ወያእምሩ፡ ንዋየ፡ እግዚአብሔር፡ ከመ፡ ሶበ፡ ይመውት፡
ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ይምልክ፡ ንዋየ፡ ወየሀብ፡ ለዘፈቀደ፤ ከመ፡
ኢይትሀጐል፡ ንዋየ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ በምክንያተ፡ ንዋየ፡ ቤተ፡
ክርስቲያን፡ አው፡ ለእመቦ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ብእሲተ፡
ወውሉደ፡ ወአዝማደ፡ አው፡ አግብርተ፤ እስመ፡ ኢኮነ፡
ርቱዐ፡ ከመ፡ ይትሀጐል፡ ንዋየ፡ ቤተ፡ ክርስቲያን፡ እስመ፡
ኢያእመሩ፡ ንዋየ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፤ ወከመ፡ ኢይትሀጐል፡
ንዋየ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ወአዝማዱሁ፡ በእንተ፡ ምክንያተ፡
ንዋየ፡ ቤተ፡ ክርስቲያን፡ ወይወድቁ፡ ውስተ፡ ጸማ፡
ወይዐርፉ፡ ላዕለ፡ ሞቱ ።

CANON 30

And they shall know the bishop's own goods, if he has any of his own, and they shall know which are the Lord's goods; so that the bishop, if he is about to die, may dispose of his own goods and give them to whom he will. Otherwise, the bishop's goods will perish under pretext of the church's goods – or perhaps he has a wife and children and kindred or servants. For, it is not rightⁱ that the goods of the church should perish because men were ignorant of the bishop's goods; nor is it right that the goods of the bishop and of his kindred should perish under pretext of the church's goods, and that his kindred should fall into misery and speak ill of his death.

CANON 30

ⁱ The words **ኢኮነ፡ ርቱዐ፡** ('it is not right') are to be connected with what follows, even in the Coptic version. In the Greek and other versions, however, they are connected with the preceding clause.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፴፩ ።

በእንተ፡ ተአምኖ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ላዕለ፡ ንዋየ፡ ቤተ፡ ክርስቲያን ። ንኤዝዝ፡ እንከ፡ ከመ፡ ይኩን፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ዘይመልክ፡ ንዋየ፡ ቤተ፡ ክርስቲያን፤ እስመ፡ ኮነ፡ ዘተአመነ፡ ላዕለ፡ ነፍሳተ፡ ሰብእ፡ ክቡር፤ ምንተ፡ እንከ፡ ኩሎ፡ ንዋየ፡ ዘተውህበ፡ ሎቱ፡ ከመ፡ የአዝዞሙ፡ በፈቃዱ፡ ወይሴሲ፡ ነዳያነ፡ እምኔሁ፡ በእደ፡ ቀሳውስት፡ ወዲያቆናት፡ በፈሪህ፡ እግዚአብሔር፡ ወበረዓድ ። ወይርክብ፡ ለሊሁኒ፡ እምኔሁ፡ ለመፍቅዱ፡ ለእመ፡ ኮነ፡ ጽኑስ፡ በእንተ፡ ዘይፈቅዱ፡ በኅቤሁ፡ አኅው፡ ነግድ፡ እለ፡ ይሔውጽዎ፡ ከመ፡ ኢይኅጥአሙ፡ እምዘፈቀዱ፡ በኅቤሁ፤ እስመ፡ ሕገ፡ እግዚአብሔር፡ ይኤዝዞሙ፡ ለእለ፡ ይፀመዱ፡ ለምሥዋዕ፡ ይሴሰዩ፡ እምሥዋዕ፤ እስመ፡ ኢይጸብኡ፡ ሐራሁ፡ ለንጉሥ፡ ኀበ፡ ጸላእቱ፡ በሲሳየ፡ ነፍሶሙ ።

CANON 31

So, we order that the bishop be the one who has authority over the goods of the church. For, he it is to whom the precious souls of men have been entrusted; how much more, then, that all the goods should be committed to him, that he may dispose of them according to his own judgment, and supply from them to the needy by the hands of the presbyters and deacons, with all fear of God and trembling. Let the bishop himself also take from them for his own necessity, if he is in want of those things that visiting brothers from abroad ask of him, lest they lack the things they sought from him. For, the law of the Lord commands that those who serve at the altar should also be fed from the altar; because the soldiers of the king do not fight against his enemy at their own charges.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፴፪ ።

በእንተ፡ እለ፡ የሐውሩ፡ ኀበ፡ ተውኔት ።

ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ አው፡ ቀሲስ፡ አው፡ ዲያቆን፡ ዘየሐውር፡ ኀበ፡ ተውኔት፡ ወየዐውድ፡ ወያበዝኅ፡ ስካረ፡ ለይኅድግ፤ ወእመ፡ አኮ፡ ይሰደድ ። ንፍቀ፡ ዲያቆን፡ ወአናጉንስጢስ፡ ወመዘምራን፡ ለእመ፡ ገብⁱሩ፡ ዘንተ፡ ምግባረ፡ ለይኅድግ፤ ወእመ፡ እኮ፡ ይሰደዱ ። ወከማሁ፡ ሕዝባውያንኒ ። ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ አው፡ ቀሲስ፡ አው፡ ዲያቆን፡ ዘያአምር፡ ዘየሐውር፡ ወኢየኅድግ፡ መፍትው፡ በድልው፡ ይከልክ፤ ወእመ፡ አኮ፡ ይትመተር ።

CANON 32

ON THOSE WHO FREQUENT THE THEATRES

A bishop or presbyter or deacon who frequents the theatres, or wanders about, or gives himself to drunkenness, let him cease; if not, let him be cut off. A subdeacon and reader and cantor, if they do these things, let them cease; if not, let them be cut off. And so likewise the laity.ⁱⁱ If a bishop, priest, or deacon knows of someone who goes and does not give up this habit, he shall rebuke him firmly; if not, he shall be deposed.

CANON 32

ⁱ Fell marks this letter with an over-written 'X', indicating that it is almost certainly incorrect.

ⁱⁱ The Ge'ez appears to be corrupt here and Lumpkin lacks the text after this footnote mark. Four canons that follow at this point in the Greek are absent from both the Ge'ez and the Coptic.

ትእዛዝ፡፴ወ፫ ።

ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ አው፡ ቀሲስ፡ አው፡ ዲያቆን፡ ዘየሐውር፡ ኀበ፡
ጥምቀተ፡ ዕልዋን፡ አው፡ ኀበ፡ ቊርባኖሙ፡ ንሕነ፡ ንኤዝዝ፡
ከመ፡ ይትመተር ። ምንተ፡ እንከ፡ ይእቲ፡ ሥምረቱ፡
ለክርስቶስ፡ ምስለ፡ ሰይጣን፤ ወአይ፡ ክፍል፡ ለመሃይምናን፡
ምስለ፡ ዘኢየሱስ ።

CANON 33

As for a bishop or presbyter or deacon who resorts to the baptism of the uncircumcisedⁱ or to their sacrifice, we command that he be deposed. For, what fellowship has Christ with Satan? And what partnership have the faithful with the unbeliever?

CANON 33

ⁱ In place of ‘*the uncircumcised*’, Lumpkin has ‘*heretics*’ (the Ethiopian Orthodox Tewahedo Church practises circumcision).

ትእዛዝ፡ ፴፬ ።

በእንተ፡ ሥርዐቱ፡ ለዘያስተራኹስ፡ አውስቦ ።

እመሂ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ አው፡ ቀሲስ፡ አው፡ ዲያቆን፡ አው፡
፩እምሥዩማን፡ ካህናት፡ ዘአበየ፡ አውስቦ፡ ወበሊዐ፡ ሥጋ፡
ወሰትየ፡ ወይን፡ ወአኮ፡ በእንተ፡ ተፀምዶ፡ አላ፡ ከመ፡
ርኩሳን፡ ወረሰዮሙ፡ መጽሐፍ፡ⁱ ከመ፡ ኩሎሙ፡ ሠናይ፡
ወእግዚአብሔር፡ ፈጠሮ፡ ለሰብእ፡ ተባዕተ፡ ወአንስተ፡
ወከመዝ፡ ውእቱ፡ ዘይዐርፍ፡ አይኅድግ፤ ወእመ፡ አኮ፡
ለይትመተር፡ ወይፃእ፡ እምቤተ፡ ክርስቲያን ። ወከማሁ፡
ሕዝባዊ ።

CANON 34

ON THE CASE OF ONE WHO RECKONS MARRIAGE UNCLEAN

A bishop or presbyter or deacon or any of the clergy who abhors marriage and the eating of flesh and the drinking of wine – and this by no means for the sake of temperance, but as though these things were foul, while the Scripture declares them all to be good, and God made man male and female – and who blasphemes in such a manner: let him cease; if not, let him be deposed and depart from the church. And so likewise a layman.

CANON 34

- ⁱ Since all the MSS present ወረሰዮሙ፡ መጽሐፍ፡, Fell did not venture to alter this reading, even though the construction of the words is rather convoluted. He had no doubt, however – supported by the Greek (ἐπιλαθόμενος) and the Coptic versions (ἐλατρωμένος) – that those words are a corruption of ረሰዖሙ፡ (or rather, since a single person is involved, ረሰዖ፡) መጽሐፈ፡, arising from a lapse of memory regarding the Scripture (which says): that all things are good. In fact, Recension II reads ረሰዖሙ፡.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፴፩ ።

በእንተ፡ ምትረቱ፡ ለዘኢይትዌከፎሙ፡ ለእለ፡ ይትኔሰሑ፡
እምነጢአቶሙ ።

ለእመ፡ ኢፈቀደ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ አው፡ ቀሲስ፡ አው፡ ዲያቆን፡
ኢይትዌከፎ፡ ለዘይትኔሳሕ፡ እምነጢአቱ፡ ለይትመተር፤
እስመ፡ አሕመመ፡ ልበ፡ እግዚእነ፡ ዘይቤ፡ ይከውን፡ ፍሥሓ፡
በሰማያት፡ በእንተ፡ ፩ኃጥእ፡ ዘይትኔሳሕ ።

CANON 35

ON THE DEPOSING OF ONE WHO DOES NOT RECEIVE THE
PENITENT

If any bishop or presbyter or deacon does not receive one who is doing penance for his sin: let him be deposed, since he has grieved the heart of the Lord, who said, "There shall be joy in heaven over one sinner who repents."

ትእዛዝ፡ ፴፬ ።

ለእመ፡ ኢበልዐ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ አው፡ ቀሲስ፡ አው፡
ዲያቆን፡ ንስቲተ፡ ሥጋ፡ ወኢስትየ፡ ኅዳጠ፡ ወይነ፡
በመዋዕለ፡ በዓላት፡ ወበኅቡእ፡ ያስተነፍሮሙ፡ ወኮነ፡ መርሐ፡
ለዕቅፍተ፡ ሕዝብ፡ ለይትመተር ።

CANON 36

If any bishop or presbyter or deacon does not eat a little flesh
nor drink a little wine on feast days, and secretly judges these
things to be foul, and in this way becomes to the people the
cause of offence: let him be deposed.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፴፬ ።

ለእመ፡ ተረክበ፡ ፩እምካህናት፡ ዘይበልዕ፡ በውስተ፡
ምሥዶጣት፡ ወይስቲ፡ ይትፈለጥ፤ አላ፡ ለእመ፡ ኮነ፡
በማኅደረ፡ ነግድ፡ በእንተ፡ ምንዳቤ፡ በፍኖት ።

ወለእመ፡ ጸዐለ፡ ፳እምሥዩማን፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ለይትመተር፤
እስመ፡ ይቤ፡ ለመኰንን፡ ሕዝብከ፡ ኢታሕሥም፡ ቃለ ።

ወለእመ፡ ጸዐለ፡ ፩እምንኡሳን፡ ካህናት፡ ቀሲስ፡ አው፡
ዲያቆን፡ ይሰደድ ።

ወለእመ፡ ተሳለቀ፡ ፩እምካህናት፡ ጽሙመ፡ አው፡ ሐንካሰ፡
አው፡ ዕዉረ፡ አው፡ ዘፅዉስ፡ እገሪሁ፡ ይሰደድ ። ወከማሁ፡
ሕዝባዊኒ፡ ለእመ፡ ገብረ፡ ዘንተ ።

CANON 37

If any of the clergy is caught eating and drinking in taverns: let him be cut off; unless it be done at an inn out of necessity upon a journey.

And if any of the clergy treats the bishop with contempt: let him be deposed. For, the Scripture says, "You shall not curse the ruler of your people."

And if any of the lower clergy treats a presbyter or deacon with contempt: let him be cut off.

And if any of the clergy mocks a man who is deaf or lame or blind or crippled in his feet: let him be cut off. And so likewise a layman who does such things.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፴፬ ።

በእንተ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ አው፡ ቀሲስ፡ ዘኢይሜህር፡

ለሕዝብ፡ ተቀንዮ፡ ለእግዚአብሔር ።

ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ አው፡ ቀሲስ፡ ዘያሰትት፡ ለካህናት፡ ወለሕዝብ፡
ወኢይሜህሮሙ፡ መልእክተ፡ እግዚአብሔር፡ ይሰደድ፤
ወለእመ፡ ነበረ፡ በአስትቶ፡ ይሰወር ።

CANON 38

ON A BISHOP OR PRESBYTER WHO DOES NOT TEACH THE PEOPLE
THE WORSHIP OF GOD

A bishop or presbyter who neglects the clergy and the people,
and does not teach them the divine office, let him be cut off;
and if he persists in his negligence, let him be deposed.

ትእዛዝ፡ ሽወ፱ ።

ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ አው፡ ቀሲስ፡ ለእመ፡ ተሀየየ፡ በእንተ፡
ዘይጸኒስ፡ እምካህናት፡ ወኢያስተማስሎ፡ በዘይሁቦ፡
ለመፍቅዱ፡ ይሰደድ ። ወለእመ፡ ነበረ፡ በተሀይዮ፡ ይሰወር፡
ከመ፡ ዘቀተለ፡ እኅሁ ።

CANON 39

A bishop or presbyter who has no care for a cleric labouring in want, and does not repent of it,ⁱ let him be cut off. And, if he persists in his neglect: let him be deposed, as one who has killed his own brother.

CANON 39

ⁱ The translation, ‘and does not repent of it’, is uncertain; Lumpkin reads ‘and does not hold him as his equal, supplying him according to his need’ but this seems too long for the Ge’ez text.

ትእዛዝ፡፺

እመቦ፡ ዘኣርአየ፡ መጻሕፍተ፡ ዘጸሐፉ፡ ዕልዋን፡ በሐሰት፡
ወኣብኣ፡ ውስተ፡ ቤተ፡ ክርስቲያን፡ ከመ፡ ዘቅዱሳት፡
መጻሕፍት፡ ለመሥገረተ፡ ሕዝብ፡ ወካህናት፡ ይሰዐር ።

CANON 40

If anyone publishes books written falselyⁱ by heretics, and
brings them into the church as though they were holy books,
to ensnare the people and the clergy: let him be deposed.

CANON 40

ⁱ The Coptic has 'in a lie or falsehood' (ⲃⲉⲛ ⲟⲩⲙⲉⲧⲛⲟⲩⲗ).

ትእዛዝ፡፵ወ፩ ።

በእንተ፡ ካህን፡ ዘይዛለፍዎ፡ ሕዝብ፡ በዝሙት፡ ኣው፡
ካልእ ።

እመ፡ ኮነ፡ ጋእⁱ፡ ኅበ፡ መሃይምናን፡ በዝሙት፡ ኣው፡
በምርዕት፡ ኣው፡ በካልእ፡ ግብር፡ ዘኢይደሉ፡ ወለእመ፡
ተዛለፍዎ፡ ኢይኩን፡ እምካህናት ።

CANON 41

ON A CLERIC WHOM THE PEOPLE CONVICT OF FORNICATION OR
OTHER OFFENCE

If a cleric commits adultery or fornication or another act that is
not right, and if they are accused of it, they shall not be among
the clergy. ⁱⁱ

CANON 41

- ⁱ Fell marks this letter with an over-written 'X', indicating that it is almost certainly incorrect.
- ⁱⁱ Lumpkin has a rather longer text for this verse, but the sense is the same: *If among the faithful an accusation is brought against a cleric concerning fornication or wantonness or any other deed that is unseemly, and they convict him: let him be no longer among the clergy.*

ትእዛዝ፡ ሻወ፪ ።

በእንተ፡ ክሕደተ፡ ክርስቶስ፡ ወክሕደተ፡ ክህነት ።

፩እምሥዩማን፡ ለእመ፡ ክሕደ፡ በእንተ፡ ፍርሀተ፡ ሰብእ፡
አው፡ እምአይሁድ፡ አው፡ እምአረሚ፡ ወዕልዋን፡ ለእመ፡
ኮነ፡ ውእቱ፡ ስመ፡ ክርስቶስ፡ ዘክሕደ፡ ይሰደድ፤ ወለእመ፡
ኮነ፡ ውእቱ፡ ስመ፡ ክህነት፡ ይሰወር ። ወለእመ፡ ተነስሐ፡
ይትወከፍዎ፡ ወይባእ፡ ከመ፡ ሕዝባዊ ።

CANON 42

ON DENYING CHRIST AND ON DENYING THE PRIESTHOODⁱ

If any of the clergy, through fear of men – whether of Jews, or of the heathen and heretics – makes denial: let him be cut off, if it is the name of Christ that he denied. But, if it was the name of the clergy: let him be deposed. And, if he does penance, let them receive him; but let him enter as a layman.

CANON 42

ⁱ In place of ‘*the Priesthood*’, Lumpkin has ‘*the Dignity of the Clergy*’.

ትእዛዝ፡፵ወሮ ።

ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ አው፡ ቀሲስ፡ አው፡ ዲያቆን፡ አው፡
፩እምካህናት፡ ሥዩማን፡ ለእመ፡ በልዑ፡ ሥጋ፡ ዘቦቱ፡ ደመ፡
ነፍሱ፡ ዘኢጥቡሕ፡ አው፡ ዘነሰኮ፡ አርቄ፡ አው፡ ማውታ፡
ለይሰወር፡ ውእቱ፤ በከመ፡ አዘዘ፡ ቦቱ፡ ሕግ ። ወለእመ፡
ኮነ፡ ሕዝባዊ፡ ይሰደድ ።

CANON 43

If any bishop or presbyter or deacon or any of the clergy eats
flesh in which is the blood of its life, not slaughtered, or torn
by beasts, or that died of itself: let him be deposed, as the law
appoints in this matter. And, if he is a layman: let him be cut
off.

ትእዛዝ፡ ህወ፬ ።

ለእመ፡ ተረክበ፡ ፩እምካህናት፡ ዘይጸውም፡ በዕለተ፡ እሑድ፡
አው፡ በዕለተ፡ ሰንበት፡ ዘእንበለ፡ ሰንበት፡ ዐባይ፡ ባሕቲታ፡
እንተ፡ ፋሲካ፡ ይሰዐር ።

CANON 44

If any of the clergy is found to have fasted on the Lord's Day
or on the Sabbath – except only on the Great Sabbath of the
Paschaⁱ: let him be deposed.

CANON 44

ⁱ The words, እንተ፡ ፋሲካ፡ ('of the Pascha') are also included in the Coptic (ⲛⲧⲉ ⲡⲓⲁⲥⲭⲁ).

ትእዛዝ፡ግዓዝ፡።

CANON 45

ለእመ፡ ቦአ፡ ፩እምካህናት፡ አው፡ ሕዝባዊ፡ ውስተ፡ ምክራብ፡ አይሁድ፡ ወመካነ፡ ዕልዋን፡ ከመ፡ ይጸሊ፡ⁱ ከህናት፡ ይሰወሩ፡ ወሕዝባዊ፡ ይሰደድ ።

If any of the clergy or of the laity enters the synagogue of the Jews or the place of heretics to pray – if he is a cleric, let him be deposed; and, if a layman, let him be cut off.

CANON 45

ⁱ Fell thought that the reading of the MSS (ይጸሊ) should be emended here (to ይጸልዩ), as it this word seems to have crept in because scribes mistakenly thought it should be joined with the following word (ከህናት).

ትእዛዝ፡ ሻወጌ ።

በእንተ፡ ዘይዘብጥ፡ ሰብአ፡ እስከ፡ ይመውት፡ ወዘይትኃየል፡
ድንግለ ።

ካህን፡ ለእመ፡ ተባእሰ፡ ምስለ፡ ካልኡ፡ ወይዘብጦ፡
ወይመውት፡ ይሰወር፡ በእንተ፡ ግዝፈተ፡ ልቡ፤ ወለእመ፡ ኮነ፡
ሕዝባዊ፡ ይሰደድ ።

ወለእመ፡ ኮነ፡ ሕዝባዊ፡ ተዐጋፊ፡ ድንግል፡ እምቅድመ፡
ትትፈኅር፡ ወይከውን፡ ምስሌሃ፡ ይሰደድ ። ወኢያውስብ፡
ካልእተ፤ አሳ፡ ይንበር፡ ምስለ፡ እንተ፡ ተጓየላ፡ ወለእመሂ፡
ኮነት፡ ነዳይተ፡ ወሕሥምተ ።

CANON 46

ON ONE WHO STRIKES A MAN SO THAT HE DIES AND ON ONE
WHO DOES VIOLENCE TO A VIRGIN

If a cleric quarrels with another and strikes him, and that man
dies: let him be deposed, for the hardness of his heart. And if
he is a layman: let him be cut off.

If a layman deceives a virgin before she is betrothed, and lives
with her: let him be cut off. And let him not take another, but
remain with her whom he violated, even though she be poor
and ill-favouredⁱ.

CANON 46

ⁱ Fell prints *nequam* for the last word, queries whether it means ‘despised’, and a hand in his own copy glosses it *deformis*. The Ge’ez has **ሕሥምተ**, whose first sense is ‘ugly’ or ‘deformed’ and whose second is ‘vile’ (that is why the annotator wrote *deformis*). An early edition of Lumpkin’s translation read ‘*of no account*’, which takes only the second sense; ‘*ill-favoured*’ is used now as covering both, though the word would bear a plainer rendering.

ትእዛዝ፡ ሻወጊ ።

በእንተ፡ ዘይሠየም፡ ካዕበ ።

ለእመ፡ ረከበ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ አው፡ ቀሲስ፡ አው፡ ዲያቆን፡
ክልኤተ፡ ጊዜ፡ ተሠይመ፡ ይሰዐር፡ ውእቱኒ፡ ወዘሤም፤ አላ፡
ለእመ፡ ተዐውቀ፡ ከመ፡ ተሠይሙ፡ እምነበ፡ ዕልዋን፤
እስመ፡ ኢይከውን፡ ግሙራ፡ ከመ፡ ይኩኑ፡ እለ፡ ተጠምቁ፡
አው፡ ተሠይሙ፡ እምነበ፡ ሰብእ፡ ዘከመዝ፡ ይከውኑ፡
መሃይምናን፡ ወኢካህናተ ።

CANON 47

ON ONE WHO IS ORDAINED AGAINⁱ

If any bishop or presbyter or deacon receives ordination a second time; let both he himself and the one who ordained him be deposed; unless perhaps it is certain that they were ordained by heretics. For, those who have been baptised or ordained by men of that kind can by no means be faithful or clergy.

CANON 47

ⁱ In place of 'again', Lumpkin has 'a second time'.

ትእዛዝ፡ ሃወጥ ።

በእንተ፡ ዘኢይጸውም፡ ጾመ፡ አርብዓ፡
ወረቡዕ፡ ወዐርብ ።

ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ አው፡ ቀሲስ፡ አው፡ ዲያቆን፡ አው፡
አናጉንሰጢስ፡ አው፡ መዘምር፡ ለእመ፡ ኢጾመ፡ አርብዓ፡
ቅዱስ፡ ወረቡዕ፡ ወዐርብ፡ ይሰዐር፡ ለእመ፡ ኢክልኦ፡ ሕማም፡
ዘሥጋ ። ወለእመ፡ ኮነ፡ ሕዝባዊ፡ ይሰደድ ።

CANON 48

ON ONE WHO DOES NOT FAST THE FORTY [DAYSⁱ] AND THE
FOURTH AND SIXTH DAYS

If any bishop or presbyter or deacon or reader or cantor does
not fast in the holy forty days, and on the fourth and the sixth
dayⁱⁱ : let him be deposed; unless sickness of body has
hindered him. And if he is a layman: let him be cut off.

CANON 48

ⁱ The word, '*Days*', is not present here in the Ge'ez, but is implied.

ⁱⁱ The fourth and sixth days are Wednesday and Friday.

ትእዛዝ፡፵ወ፱ ።

CANON 49

ለእመ፡ ጾመ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ አው፡ ቀሲስ፡ አው፡ ዲያቆን፡
አው፡ ፩እምሥዩማን፡ ምስለ፡ አይሁድ፡ ወይገብር፡ ፋሲካ፡
ምስሌሆሙ፡ አው፡ ይትወከፍ፡ በኅቤሆሙ፡ አምኃ፡
በዓሎሙ፡ⁱ ናእተ፡ አው፡ ዘይመስሎ፡ ይሰወር፤ ወለእመ፡ ኮነ፡
ሕዝባዊ፡ ይሰደድ ።

ሕዝባዊ፡ ለእመ፡ ወሰደ፡ ኀበ፡ ምኽራብ፡ አሕዛብ፡
ወምኽራብ፡ አይሁድ፡ ቅብአ፡ ወማኅቶተ፡ ይሰደድ ።

If any bishop or presbyter or deacon, or any of the clergy, fasts
with the Jews, or keeps the Pascha with them, or accepts from
them the gifts of their feast – unleavened bread or something
similar, let him be deposed. And, if he is a layman: let him be
cut off.

If any layman brings oil and lamps into the temple of the
heathen or into the temple of the Jews: let him be cut off.

CANON 49

ⁱ Fell has here adopted the reading አምኃ፡ በዓሎሙ፡ (*'gifts of their feast'*), following the Coptic version; *Codex B* has አምኃ፡ በበዓሎሙ፡ (*'gifts on their feast day'*).

ትእዛዝ፡ ፶ ።

በእንተ፡ ዘይሰርቅ፡ ዘይተ፡ አው፡ ሠምዐ፡ አው፡ ዘኮነ፡
እምንዋየ፡ ቤተ፡ ክርስቲያን ።

ለእመ፡ ሰረቀ፡ ሥዩም፡ ሠምዐ፡ ቤተ፡ ክርስቲያን፡ አው፡
ቅብአ፡ ለይሰደድ፤ ወይፍዲ፡ ዘሰረቀ፡ ትኅምስተ ።

ንዋየ፡ ብሩር፡ ወአልባስ፡ ለእመ፡ አስተርአየ፡ ኅዳጠ፡
መዋዕለ፡ⁱⁱ ኢይንሣእ፡ ሰብእ፡ እምኔሁ፡ ምንተኒ፡ ለርእሱ፡
ባሕቲቱ፤ እስመ፡ ዝንቱ፡ ግብር፡ ኅጢአት፡ ውእቱ ።
ወለእመሶ፡ ዘገብረ፡ ዘንተ፡ ይስድድዎ፡ ወይትበቀልዎ ።

CANON 50

ON ONE WHO STEALS OIL OR WAX OR ANYTHING THAT
BELONGS TO THE CHURCH

If any cleric steals the wax of the church or its oil: let him be
cut off, and let him repay fivefold what he stole. ⁱ

Of the silver vessels and the vestments, if they are on view for
a few days, let no one take anything for himself alone; for this
is sin. And, if he does so: let them cut him off and take
vengeance on him.

CANON 50

- ⁱ The Coptic version also reads similarly (ⲛⲉⲙ ⲡⲉⲣⲕⲱⲃ ⲉ ⲛⲟⲡ); however, the Greek texts have *καὶ τὸ ἐπίπεμτον προστιθέτω μεθ' οὗ ἔλαβεν* ('and let him add the fifth part to the amount he received').
- ⁱⁱ Fell prints these 4 words (ለእመ፡ አስተርአየ፡ ኅዳጠ፡ መዋዕለ፡) as obscure and says plainly that he does not know what they mean; his Latin takes ኅዳጠ፡ for a form of the word meaning 'few', giving 'on view for a few days'; however, it may instead belong to the verb meaning to be wanting, which would give 'if they are found missing for some days', a sense that suits a canon about stealing the goods of the church better. Neither is certain and the passage wants a specialist in Ge'ez.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፶፩ ።

በእንተ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ዘአስተዋደይዎ ።

ሶበ፡ ያስተዋድይዎ፡ ለኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ሰብእ፡ መሃይምኖን፡
ጻድቃን፡ ወኄራን፡ ግብር፡ ውእቱ፡ ይጸውዕዎ፡ ኀበ፡ ኤጲስ፡
ቆጶሳት ። ወለእመ፡ መጽአ፡ ወይትአመን፡ ኀጢአቶ፡ ካዕበ፡
ይዛለፍዎ፡ ወይፍትሑ፡ ላዕሌሁ፡ በኲንኔ፡ ዘይደሉ ። ወለእመ፡
ጸውዕዎ፡ ወኢመጽአ፡ ወይጸውዕዎ፡ ካዕበ፡ ኀበ፡ ኤጲስ፡
ቆጶሳት፡ ወ፪ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶሳት፡ ይልአኩ፡ ኀቤሁ ። ወለእመ፡
ኢተሰጥወ፡ ካዕበ፡ ይጸውዕዎ፡ ሥልሰ፡ ወይልአኩ፡ ኀቤሁ፡
ዳግመ፡ ፪ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶሳት ። ወለእመ፡ ኢተሰጥወ፡ ወአስተተ፡
ወኢመጽአ፡ ይፍትሑ፡ ላዕሌሁ፡ እለ፡ ተጋብኡ፡ በዘይደሉ፡
ከመ፡ ይኩን፡ ከመ፡ ዘተዛለፍዎ፡ እስመ፡ ጐየ፡ እምፍትሕ ።

CANON 51

ON A BISHOP WHOM THEY HAVE ACCUSED

When faithful, just, and upright men accuse a bishop,ⁱ they must summon him before the bishops. If he comes and confesses his sin, then let them rebuke him and, in judgment, decree against him what is just. But, if they summon him and he does not come, let them summon him a second time before the bishops and send two bishops to him.ⁱⁱ And, if he does not obey, and scorns the summons, and does not come, then let those who are assembled decree against him what is lawful, so that it may be done to him as to one convicted, because he has fled from the judgment.

CANON 51

ⁱ Lumpkin adds ‘of a crime’ (as also in the title).

ⁱⁱ Lumpkin adds, “And if, again, he does not obey: let them summon him a third time, and send to him again two bishops.”

ትእዛዝ፡ ፶፬ ።

ከመ፡ ኢይስምዑ፡ ስምዐ፡ ዕልው፡ ላዕለ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡
ወኢስምዐ፡ አሐዱ ።

ኢይትወከፉ፡ ስምዐ፡ ዕልዋን፡ ላዕለ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፤
ወኢይትወከፉ፡ ስምዐ፡ አሐዱ፤ እስመ፡ በአፈ፡ ፪ወ፫፡
ይቁም፡ ኩሉ፡ ነገር ።

ወኢይከውኖ፡ ለኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ የሀብ፡ ሢመተ፡ ኤጲስ፡
ቆጶስና፡ ለእጉሁ፡ አው፡ ለወልዱ፡ አው፡ ለአዝማዲሁ ።
ወኢይሢም፡ ዘፈቀደ፤ እስመ፡ ኢኮነ፡ ርቱዐ፡ ከመ፡
ይትዋረሱ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስና፤ ወኢየሀብ፡ ንዋየ፡
እግዚአብሔር፡ በእንተ፡ ፈቃደ፡ ሰብእ፤ ወኢይደሉ፡
ይርስያ፡ ለቤተ፡ ክርስቲያኑ፡ ለክርስቶስ፡ ርስተ ። ለእመ፡
ገብሩ፡ ከመዝ፡ ወይነሥኡ፡ ከመዝ፡ ሢመተ፡ ይኩኑ፡ ከመ፡
ዘአልቦ፤ ወለሊሁኒ፡ ይትኩነን፡ በፍትሕ ።

፩ዘነቋር፡ ዐይኑ፡ አው፡ ሐንካሰ፡ እግሩ፡ ወይደልዎ፡
ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስና፡ ይሠየም፤ እስመ፡ ነውረ፡ ሥጋ፡
ኢያረኩሶ፡ አላ፡ ነውረ፡ ነፍስ ።

ጽመም፡ ወዕዉር፡ ኢይሠየም፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፤ አኮ፡
ርኩስ፡ ከዊኖ፡ አላ፡ ከመ፡ ኢይዘረዉ፡ ንዋየ፡ ቤተ፡
ክርስቲያን ።

ዘቦ፡ ጋኔን፡ ኢይሠየም፡ ካህነ፤ ወኢይጸሊ፡ ምስለ፡
መሃይምናን ። ወለእመ፡ ነጽሐ፡ ያብእዎ፤ ወለእመ፡
ይደልዎ፡ ይሠየም፡ ካህነ ።

CANON 52

THAT THEY SHOULD NOT HEAR THE TESTIMONY OF A HERETIC
AGAINST A BISHOP, NOR THE TESTIMONY OF ONE MAN

Let not the bishops receive the testimony of a heretic against a bishop, nor let them receive the testimony of one man; for by the mouth of two and three shall every word stand.

And it is not lawful for a bishop to bestow the episcopal office on his brother, his son, or his kin, nor to ordain whomever he wishes. For, it is not right that the episcopal office be inherited. Nor let him bestow the goods of God according to the will of men; nor is it fitting to make the Church of Christ an inheritance. If they do this and obtain office in such a manner, let them be as one whose ordination is nothing; and let him who ordained be judged by the law.

He who is one-eyed, or who limps on his foot, and is worthy of the episcopate: let him be ordained; for, a blemish of the body does not defile him, but a blemish of the soul.

A man who is dumb or blind shall not be ordained bishop – not because he is unclean, but lest the goods of the church be scattered.

He who has a demon, let him not be ordained a cleric, nor let him pray with the faithful. But, if he is made clean: let them receive him; and if he is worthy, let him be ordained a cleric.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፶፬ ።

ኢይሠየም፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ዘተጠምቀ፡ ሐዲስ ።

ዘመጽኦ፡ እምኦሕዛብ፡ ኣው፡ ዘሐይወ፡ በእኩይ፡ ወተጠምቀ፡ ኢመፍትው፡ ይሠየም፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ በጊዜሃ፤ ወኢመፍትው፡ ለዘኢተመከረ፡ ይኩን፡ መምህረ፡ ለባዕዳን፡ ሰብእ፤ ኣላ፡ ይኩን፡ ዝንቱ፡ በጸጋ፡ እግዚአብሔር ።

ወኢይደልዎ፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ ከመ፡ ይንበር፡ ወያስተጋብእ፡ ምርካብ፡ ኣላ፡ ያስተርከብ፡ ግብረ፡ ቤተ፡ ክርስቲያን፤ ወለእመኦኮስ፡ ይገብር፡ ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስና ። ኣልቦ፡ ዘይክል፡ ለክልኤ፡ ኣጋእዝት፡ ተቀንዮ፡ በከመ፡ ኣዘዘ፡ እግዚእን ።

ኢንኤዝዝ፡ ከመ፡ ይሠየም፡ ገብር፡ ካህነ፡ ዘእንበለ፡ በመባሕተ፡ ኣጋእዝቲሁ፡ ከመ፡ ኢይኅዝኑ፡ ኣጋእዝቲሁ፤ እስመ፡ በዝንቱ፡ የሐጽጽ፡ ኣብያቲሆሙ ። ወለእመ፡ ተረክቦ፡ ገብር፡ በጊዜሁ፡ ዘይደልዎ፡ መዓርገ፡ ሢመት፡ በከመ፡ ኣስተርኣየ፡ ለነ፡ ኣናሲሞስ፡ ወያግዕዝዎ፡ ኣጋእዝቲሁ፡ ወያውፅእዎ፡ እምኣብያቲሆሙ፡ ወይሠየም ።

CANON 53

THAT ONE NEWLY BAPTISED SHOULD NOT BE ORDAINED BISHOP

He who comes from the heathen, or has lived in wickedness and been baptised, may not lawfully be ordained bishop at once; nor is it fitting that he who has not been proved should be the teacher of men; but let this be by the grace of God.

It is not lawful for a bishop to be continually heaping up riches, but let him give himself to the affairs of the church; if not, he does not discharge the episcopal office. No man can serve two masters, as our Lord appointed.

We appoint that a slave not be ordained a cleric without the permission of his masters, lest his masters be grieved; for, by this, their household is diminished. But if at any time a slave is found who is worthy of the rank of ordination – as Onesimusⁱ seemed to us – let his masters free him and send him out from their houses; and then let him be ordained.

CANON 53

ⁱ The name, ‘Onesimus’, is wanting in all the Ge’ez MSS; Recension II reads ‘Simon’ and the Arabic titles have ‘Aunisiphoros’. Fell supplies the name (in his Ge’ez text) from the sense.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፶፬ ።

ኤጲስ፡ ቆጶስ፡ አው፡ ቀሲስ፡ አው፡ ዲያቆን፡ ዘይፀመድ፡
ሐራ፡ ወይፈቅድ፡ ይግበሮሙ፡ ለክልኤሆሙ፡ ከመ፡ ይርከብ፡
ሢመተ፡ ሰብእ፡ ወይርከብ፡ ሢመተ፡ ክህነት፡ ይሰወር፤
እስመ፡ ይቤ፡ ሀቡ፡ ዘእግዚአብሔር፡ ለእግዚአብሔር፡
ወዘንጉሥ፡ ለንጉሥ ።

ዘያቀልል፡ ንጉሠ፡ አው፡ መኰንን፡ ዘእንበለ፡ ርቱዕ፡
ይትበቀልዎ ። ወለእመ፡ ኮነ፡ ካህነ፡ ይሰወር፤ ወለእመ፡ ኮነ፡
ሕዝባዌ፡ ይሰደድ ።

CANON 54

A bishop or presbyter or deacon who gives himself to military service and wishes to discharge both – that is, to exercise the office of menⁱ and to exercise the office of the priesthood: let him be deposed. For the Scripture says, “Render what is God’s to God, and what is Caesar’s to Caesar.”

He who unjustly despises Caesar or the magistrate: let him be punished. And if he is a cleric: let him be deposed; but if he is a layman: let him be cut off.

CANON 54

ⁱ Here, ‘men’ follows the Ge’ez text, but the Greek (ῥωμαϊκὴν) and other versions appear to have read *νῑρωμεος* (‘Romans’) instead of *νῑρωμε* (‘men’).

ትእዛዝ፡ ፶፬ ።

በእንተ፡ ዘከመ፡ ይትወከፉ፡ እመጻሕፍት፡ ዘትካት፡ ወዘሐዲስ፡
ውስተ፡ ቤተ፡ ክርስቲያን ።

ወይኩን፡ እሉ፡ መጻሕፍት፡ ኩሎሙ፡ ለካህናት፡ ወለሕዝባውያን፡
ቅዱሳን፡ ወክቡራን ። ወእሉ፡ እሙንቱ፡ እምሥርዐት፡ ዘትካት ።

CANON 55

ON HOW THE BOOKS OF THE OLD AND NEW TESTAMENTS
ARE TO BE RECEIVED IN THE CHURCH ⁱ

Let all these books be holy and honoured by the clergy and
the laity alike; and these indeed are of the Old Testament:

CANON 55

ⁱ Since there is no consensus among the Abyssinians regarding which books should be considered biblical, it is not surprising that almost every MS presents a different list. Besides the list found here, others are cited in Recension II of the Apostolic Canons, as well as in the second and third recensions of Abtilis; these, however, differ from one another. The list found in the book, *Fetha Nagast*, closely resembles that given here.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፶ ወ፮ ።

መጻሕፍት፡ ዘመሴ፤ ዘፍጥረት፤ ዘፀአት፤ ዘሌዋውያን፤
ዘኩልቀኤ፤ ዘዳግም፡ ሕግ፤ ዘኢያሱ፡ ወልደ፡ ነዌ፤
ዘመሳፍንት፤ ዘሩት፤ ፬መጻሕፍት፡ ዘነገሥት፤ ቀዳሚ፡
ወካልእ፡ ፩መጽሐፍ፡ ሣልስ፡ ወራብዕ፡ ፩መጽሐፍ፤
፪ትሩፋተ፡ ነገሥት፤ ዘዕዝራ፡ ቀዳሚ፡ ወካልእ፤ ፩መጽሐፍ፡
ዘኢዮብ፤ ዘአስቴር፤ ዘጦቢት፤ መክብብ፤ መዝሙረ፡ ዳዊት፡
፪፱፤ መሳልያተ፡ ሰሎሞን፤ ዘቤተ፡ ክርስቲያን፡ ዘጉባኤ፤
መሓልየ፡ መሓልይ፤ ፲ወ፪ንኡሳን፡ ነቢያት፤ ኢሳይያስ፤
ኤርምያስ፤ ዳንኤል፤ ሕዝቅኤል ። ዘንተ፡ መሀሩ፡
ለደቂቅክሙ ።

ዘእንበለ፡ ውእቱ፡ ጥበበ፡ ሰሎሞን፤ ዮዲት፤ ወመጻሕፍተ፡
ኩፋሌ፡ ፫፤ ዘኢያሱ፡ ወልደ፡ ሲራክ፡ ዐቢየ፡ ትምህርት ።
ወመጻሕፍትኒ፡ እሉ፡ ዘሐዲስ፡ ሕግ፤ ፬ወንጌላት፤ ዘማቴዎስ፤
ዘማርቆስ፤ ዘሉቃስ፤ ዘዮሐንስ፤ ወግብረ፡ ሐዋርያት፤
ወ፪መልእክተ፡ ጴጥሮስ፤ ፫መልእክት፡ ዘዮሐንስ፤ ፩መልእክት፡
ዘያዕቆብ፤ ፩መልእክት፡ ዘይሁዳ፤ ፲ወ፪መልእክት፡ ዘጳውሎስ፤
ወአቡቀለምሲስ፡ ዘውእቱ፡ አርአያ፡ ዮሐንስ፤ ወ፪መልእክተ፡
ቀሌምንጦስ፤

CANON 56

The books of Moses: Genesis, Exodus, Leviticus, Numbers, Deuteronomy; Joshua son of Nun; Judges; Ruth; the 4 books of Kings, of which the first and second are one book, and the third and fourth again one; the 2 books of Chronicles; Ezra, the first and the second; one book of Job; Esther; Tobit; Ecclesiastes; the 150 Psalms of David; the Proverbs of Solomon; Ecclesiasticus; the Song of Songs; and the 12 minor prophets; Isaiah; Jeremiah; Daniel; Ezekiel. These writings teach to your children.

Besides these: the Wisdom of Solomon; Judith; the 3 books of Kufaleⁱ; and the book of Jesus son of Sirach, exceedingly wise.

Then let these books of the new law also be received: the four Gospels – of Matthew, of Mark, of Luke, of John; the Acts of the Apostles; two epistles of Peter; three epistles of John; one epistle of James; one epistle of Jude; 14 epistles of Paul; and Abuqalamsisⁱⁱ, which is the vision of John; and the 2 of Qalementosⁱⁱⁱ.

CANON 56

ⁱ ‘Kufale’ (ሲራክ) is the Book of Jubilees.

ⁱⁱ ‘Abuqalamsis’ (አቡቀለምሲስ) is the Revelation of John.

ⁱⁱⁱ ‘Qalementos’ (ቀሌምንጦስ) is the Ethiopic form of the name Clement. Fell renders this entry as two epistles of Clement; its relationship to the Ethiopian work commonly called the *Book of Qalementos* requires further textual comparison – the name by itself does not settle it. Greek Apostolic Canon 85 includes both 2 Epistles of Clement and the Constitutions in 8 books, and these two entries should be distinguished when the lists are compared. The name is left here as the Ge’ez has it.

ትእዛዝ፡ ፶፬ ።

በእንተ፡ ትእዛዛተ፡ ሐዋርያት ።

ወዘንተ፡ ንኤዝዘክሙ፡ ኦኤጲስ፡ ቆጶሳት፡ በእንተ፡ ሲኖዶስ፤ እስመ፡ ለእመ፡ ሰማዕክሙ፡ ዛቲ፡ ትትባለⁱሑ፡ ወትዴኅኑ፡ ወይከውን፡ ለክሙ፡ ሰላመ፡ ለዝሉፉ ። ወለእመ፡ ኢተአዘዝክሙ፡ ወኢተወከፍክሙ፡ ዘውስቴቱ፡ ይካለቀክሙ፡ ወይከውንክሙ፡ ሐዘነ፡ በበይናቲክሙ፡ ለዝሉፉ፡ ወድኅሬሁ፡ ትረክበክሙ፡ ኩነኔ፡ ዘይደልወክሙ፡ በእንተ፡ ዕልወትክሙ ። ወእግዚአብሔር፡ ባሕቲቱ፡ ወወልዱ፡ ዋሕድ፡ ኢየሱስ፡ ክርስቶስ፡ ወመንፈስ፡ ቅዱስ፡ ገባሬ፡ ኩሉ፡ ፍጥረት፡ ይረሲክሙ፡ ለለጅለኩልክሙ፡ ሰላመ፡ ወይርዳእክሙ፡ በኩሉ፡ ኀሩት፡ እንዘ፡ ኢታንቀለቅሉ፡ ወተህልዉ፡ ዘእንበለ፡ ርስሐት፡ እንዘ፡ አልብክሙ፡ ኀጢአተ ። ወይረሲክሙ፡ ድልዋነ፡ ለመካነ፡ ሕይወት፡ ዘለዓለም፡ በወልዱ፡ ዘያፈቅሮ፡ እግዚእነ፡ ኢየሱስ፡ ክርስቶስ፡ ሕያው፡ ወመድኅኒነ፡ ዘቦቱ፡ ለክ፡ ምስሌሁ፡ ስብሐት፡ ለአብ፡ ወመንፈስ፡ ቅዱስ፡ ለዓለመ፡ ዓለም፡ አሜን ።

ዝንቱ፡ ሲኖዶስ፡ ዘሐዋርያት፡ ዘፈነዉነ፡ ምስለ፡ ቀሌምንጦስ፤ ወስብሐት፡ ለእግዚአብሔር፡ ለዓለመ፡ ዓለም፡ አሜን ።

CANON 57

ON THE CANONS OF THE APOSTLES

These things we command you, O bishops, concerning the Synod. If you hear it, you shall be safe and delivered, and there shall be peace to you for ever. But, if you do not obey, nor receive the things contained in it, Godⁱⁱ will deride you, and there shall be sorrow among you for ever; and the judgment that is your due for your disobedience shall lay hold of you.

And may the one God, and his only-begotten Son Jesus Christ, and the Holy Spirit, the creator of every creature, give to you, to each one of you, peace, and help you in every good thing, while you are not shaken; and may you be without spot, having no sin. And may he make you worthy of the dwelling place of eternal life, through his Son whom he loves, our Lord Jesus Christ, the living one and our Saviour, to whom is glory with the Father and the Holy Spirit, world without end. Amen.

THIS IS THE SYNOD OF THE APOSTLES, WHICH THEY SENT WITH CLEMENT. AND GLORY BE TO GOD, FOR EVER AND EVER. AMEN.

CANON 57

ⁱ Fell marks this letter with an over-written 'X', indicating that it is almost certainly incorrect.

ⁱⁱ The subject, 'God', is supplied, because the Ge'ez leaves the verb without one. The verb is ይካለቀክሙ ('he will deride you') and it is singular, so a singular subject has to be understood, and God is the natural one. Fell, following the Coptic, would rather emend to 'they will deride you', but that is plural where the Ge'ez form is not. The Greek reads instead that 'you shall be punished'.